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TEST CODE **01219010**

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CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

**CARIBBEAN SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE®
EXAMINATION**

ENGLISH B

Paper 01 – General Proficiency

2 hours

11 MAY 2018 (p.m.)

1. This test consists of 60 items. You will have 2 hours to answer them.
2. In addition to this test booklet, you should have an answer sheet.
3. Each item in this test has four suggested answers lettered (A), (B), (C), (D). Read each item you are about to answer and decide which choice is best.
4. On your answer sheet, find the number which corresponds to your item and shade the space having the same letter as the answer you have chosen. Look at the sample item below.

Sample Item

Which of the following are NOT used to enhance meaning in a poem?

- (A) Diction and lyric
- (B) Simile and metaphor
- (C) Symbol and assonance
- (D) Stage direction and structure

Sample Answer



The best answer to this item is “Stage direction and structure”, so (D) has been shaded.

5. If you want to change your answer, erase it completely before you fill in your new choice.
6. When you are told to begin, turn the page and work as quickly and as carefully as you can. If you cannot answer an item, go on to the next one. You may return to that item later.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

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01219010/F 2018



Items 1–10

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 1–10.

Moses is in Waterloo Station, London. There is a confused milling mob of West Indians waiting for the boat-train. Moses is sitting on a bench when a Jamaican friend, Tolroy, comes up.

- TOLROY: Aye, Moses. I didn't expect to meet you in Waterloo for arrivals.
- MOSES: The next time will be my departure, please God. The boat-train late.
- 5 TOLROY: Who you meeting?
- MOSES: Some fellar name Henry.
- TOLROY: Boy, I expecting my mother.
- MOSES: All-you fellars really have guts, yes, Tolroy. Where you going to put she, in that two-be-four you have in Harrow Road?
- 10 TOLROY: I have to look for a bigger place. You know any?
- MOSES: Look, one of your Jamaican countrymen over there waiting like a hawk for tenants. He have a lot of houses in Brixton.
- TOLROY: You know what that set-up like. A chair, a table, and he hitting you anything from three to five guineas.
- 15 MOSES: You try down by Ladbroke Grove? Since they kill Kelso, English people been evacuating like Dunkirk from the area. You bound to get a room.
- TOLROY: Down there too grim.
- MOSES: What you want, Belgravia? Park Lane?¹ Maybe you could put she up at the Dorchester² till you find a place ...
- 20 *The station loudspeaker announces the arrival of the boat-train. An English reporter comes up to them.*
- REPORTER: [English] Excuse me sir, have you just arrived from Jamaica?
- MOSES: Am ... er, yes.
- REPORTER: I'm from the Echo ... Would you like to tell me what conditions are like?
- 25 TOLROY: [Enjoying the situation] Yes, Moses, go on and tell him.

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- MOSES: Well, the situation is desperate as usual. You know that big hurricane it had a few weeks ago?
- REPORTER: Yes?
- MOSES: Well I was in that hurricane. You could ask my friend here if you think I lie. I was sitting down in my mansion when suddenly I look up and see the sky. What you think happen?
- REPORTER: What?
- MOSES: Hurricane blow the roof clean off, banana plantation lay down as if they gone asleep ...
- REPORTER: Tell me, sir, why are so many Jamaicans coming to England? Do you believe the streets are paved with gold?
- MOSES: I don't know about all of them, but sometimes in the night I see as if the Bayswater Road sparkling with diamonds. But then you look in truth you see is only stones and gravel that mix-up with the asphalt. You know of any London street what pave with gold?
- REPORTER: Thank you for that statement. I'll just talk to a few others ...
- MOSES: [Chuckling] Watch him! Like he going to tackle that family what coming off the train.
- TOLROY: [In consternation] That look like my mother! And ... and, Tanty! And Agnes and Lewis!... and the two children!
- MA: Ma! Look me over here!... [As he gets near them, panting] What is this all?
- TOLROY: [In a daze] But what Tanty doing here, Ma? And Agnes and Lewis and the children?

Adapted from Samuel Selvon, *Eldorado West One*,
Peepal Tree Press, 1998, pp. 19-20.

1. Affluent neighbourhoods
2. A luxurious hotel in London, England

1. The setting is MOST likely
- (A) an airport
 - (B) a train station
 - (C) an old boat-train
 - (D) a house in London

2. Moses' description of Tolstoy's dwelling as a "two-be-four" (line 9) indicates to the audience that it is a
- (A) wooden structure
 - (B) tenement dwelling
 - (C) squatter settlement
 - (D) small, confined space

3. The BEST explanation of the dramatic effect of the loudspeaker mentioned in the second stage direction (lines 20–21) is that it

- (A) increases the feeling of expectancy
- (B) encourages the characters to be quiet
- (C) announces the arrivals and departures
- (D) reinforces the hustle and bustle of the setting

4. Which of the following MOSTLY contributes to humour in the extract?

- (A) “The next time will be my departure, please God” (line 4)
- (B) “A chair, a table, and he hitting you anything from three to five guineas” (lines 13–14)
- (C) “What you want, Belgravia? Park Lane? Maybe you could put she up at the Dorchester” (lines 18–19)
- (D) “Do you believe that the streets are paved with gold?” (line 36)

5. The expression “waiting like a hawk for tenants” (lines 11–12) is effective in

- (A) highlighting the fear of the immigrants
- (B) pointing out the birds that flock the venue
- (C) emphasizing birds of prey as a metaphor
- (D) reinforcing the aggressive nature of the business

6. Which of the following are used to indicate that the extract portrays a Caribbean experience?

- (A) Language and diction
- (B) Dress and names of places
- (C) Tone and the reference to a hurricane
- (D) Reference to a banana plantation and gold

7. One of the themes in this extract is

- (A) travelling by air
- (B) dependent countries
- (C) searching for a better life
- (D) overpopulation and exploitation

8. Moses’ response to the reporter suggests that he

- (A) is ignorant
- (B) is being sarcastic
- (C) misunderstood the question asked
- (D) fears the reporter might embarrass him

9. Tolroy’s reaction to his family’s arrival is BEST described as

- (A) shock and relief
- (B) joyfulness and longing
- (C) anxiety and anticipation
- (D) amazement and confusion

10. How do the stage directions in lines 42 and 44, (*Chuckling*), (*In consternation*), function as an effective guide to the action on stage?

- (A) They present an indifferent emotional response.
- (B) They shift the mood from carefree to anticipation.
- (C) They heighten the suspense about Tolroy’s family.
- (D) They provide a sense of the local community in London.

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Items 11–20

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 11–20.

The Maid shows in Mrs Linde, dressed in travelling clothes, and shuts the door after her.

MRS LINDE: *(In a dispirited and somewhat hesitant voice):* Hello Nora.

NORA: *(Uncertain):* Hello —

MRS LINDE: You don't recognize me.

5 NORA: No, I don't know — but wait, I think — *(Exclaiming)* What Kristine! Is it really you?

MRS LINDE: Yes, it's me.

NORA: Kristine! To think I didn't recognize you. But then, how could I? *(More quietly)* How you've changed, Kristine!

MRS LINDE: Yes, no doubt I have. In nine — ten long years.

10 NORA: Is it so long since we met? Yes, it's all of that. Oh, these last eight years have been a happy time, believe me. And so now you've come to town, too. Made the long trip in the winter. That took courage.

MRS LINDE: I just got here by ship this morning.

15 NORA: To enjoy yourself over Christmas, of course. Oh, how lovely! Yes, enjoy ourselves, we'll do that. But take your coat off. You're not still cold? *(Helping her)* There now, let's get cozy here by the stove. No, the easy chair there! I'll take the rocker here. *(Seizing her hands)* Yes, now you have your old look again; it was only in that first moment. You're a bit more pale, Kristine — and maybe a bit thinner.

MRS LINDE: And much, much older, Nora.

20 NORA: Yes, perhaps a bit older; a tiny, bit; not much at all. *(Stopping short; suddenly serious)* Oh, but thoughtless me, to sit here, chattering away. Sweet good Kristine, can you forgive me?

MRS LINDE: What do you mean, Nora?

25 NORA: *(Softly)* Poor Kristine, you've become a widow. You poor thing, how much you must have gone through. And he left you nothing?

MRS LINDE: No.

NORA: And no children?

MRS LINDE: I thought the maid said he was a doctor, the man who came in with me.

60 NORA: Yes, that was Dr Rank — but he's not making a sick call. He's our closest friend, and he stops by at least once a day. Tell me, is it really true that you weren't in love with your husband? Why did you marry him, then?

MRS LINDE: My mother was still alive, but bedridden and helpless — and I had my two younger brothers to look after. In all conscience I didn't think I could turn him down.

NORA: No, you were right there. But was he rich at the time?

65 MRS LINDE: He was very well off, I'd say. But the business was shaky, Nora. When he died, it all fell apart, and nothing was left.

NORA: And then —?

MRS LINDE: Now it's over, Nora. My poor mother doesn't need me, for she's passed on. Nor the boys, either; they're working now and can take care of themselves.

70 NORA: How free you must feel —

MRS LINDE: No — only unspeakably empty. Nothing to live for now. (*Standing up anxiously*) That's why I couldn't take it any longer out in that desolate hole. Maybe here it'll be easier to find something to do and keep my mind occupied. If I could only be lucky enough to get a steady job, some office work —

*Adapted from Henrik Ibsen, A Doll's House,
Pearson Education Inc., 2006, pp. 206–209.*

11. The stage directions in the opening scene, (lines 1–7) reveal that the meeting between Nora and Mrs Linde is

- (A) cheerful
- (B) awkward
- (C) purposeful
- (D) businesslike

12. The audience is made aware of the season through the references to

- (A) travelling and a coat
- (B) the cold and Christmas
- (C) Christmas and the long trip
- (D) fireplaces and travelling clothes

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13. From the extract, the audience learns that Torvald
- (A) worked hard and was a good provider
 - (B) resigned his job in order to marry Nora
 - (C) overworked himself and could not travel
 - (D) was promoted at the office after his marriage
14. Which of the following adjectives BEST describe Nora?
- (A) Aloof and meek
 - (B) Warm and hospitable
 - (C) Focused and forgetful
 - (D) Lightheaded and generous
15. The BEST explanation of the dramatic impact created by the lines “and he left you nothing ... feed on” (lines 25–30) is that they
- (A) create a lighthearted atmosphere
 - (B) provide comic relief to the audience
 - (C) understate the conflict between the characters
 - (D) heighten the intrigue about Mrs Linde’s situation
16. Mrs Linde’s role is significant because she
- (A) adds to the setting and becomes part of the props
 - (B) is contrasted with Nora, representing all she is not
 - (C) symbolizes perfection and travel to foreign countries
 - (D) is a valuable friend to Nora and has been supportive
17. The BEST explanation of the function of Nora’s speech in lines 48–51 (“Yes ... my marriage”) is that it
- (A) serves to outline her financial situation
 - (B) helps to develop her character as a devoted mother
 - (C) makes the audience aware of the present tension in her marriage
 - (D) alerts the audience to her sense of loss created by her father’s death
18. What is the MAIN theme in this extract?
- (A) Death and rebirth
 - (B) Gender awareness
 - (C) Marriage and family
 - (D) Wealth and longing
19. The **real** reason for Mrs Linde’s trip is to
- (A) visit Nora and her family
 - (B) return to that desolate hole
 - (C) travel overseas after ten years
 - (D) obtain a job and start a new life
20. The MOST suitable title for this extract is
- (A) Papa’s Memories
 - (B) Friends Reunited
 - (C) Returning to Italy
 - (D) Christmas Festivities

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Items 21–30

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer Items 21–30.

Immigrant

- I see her every day
Crossing the parking lot at four,
A black anomaly within a land of snow,
A lonely and misplaced woman
5 Desperately squeezing from the land
Its celluloid¹ comforts.
- Caribbean temper chilled
By guarded hostile looks
That stop the blood more than the blizzards and the frosts
10 Of barren prairie winters,
She often wonders why.
- Not slave, neither ayah² nor domestic
But now as pedagogue³ she comes,
Wistfully seeking a better life.
- 15 To Canada, land of silver dreams,
Refuge of slave, reject and persecuted,
But when the dross of mass-produced catalogue-bought trifles
Has worn,
And when the shiny metallic coach
20 Has spluttered and groaned it's last
Somewhere upon a lonely highway
Its guts congealed by biting cold,
And when the sun petulantly hides its head,
- Then insane jungle rhythms reverberate from
25 The gaudy Hilton perched crazily upon the
Belmont Hills⁴.
And amidst the fevered tingle of rum punches
Carnival spectres arise from
Decaying baronial mansions around the
30 Queen's Park Savannah
And return to haunt her.

*Madeline Coopsammy, "Immigrant".
In Other Voices: Writings by Blacks in Canada.
William Wallace Publishers Inc, 1985.*

¹Celluloid – tough plastic used to make film and other products

²Ayah – a nurse or maid, usually native to India

³Pedagogue – teacher

⁴Belmont Hills – in Port of Spain, Trinidad

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21. To which of the following senses does the imagery in stanza 1 MAINLY appeal?
- (A) sight and touch
 - (B) touch and taste
 - (C) smell and hearing
 - (D) hearing and taste
22. The poet describes the woman as a “black anomaly” (line 3) **primarily** to
- (A) highlight the woman’s skin colour
 - (B) show that the woman goes to the parking lot every day
 - (C) create a contrast between the woman’s skin and the snow
 - (D) emphasize that the woman does not belong in the parking lot
23. The poet uses the expression “Desperately squeezing from the land / Its celluloid comforts” (lines 5–6) to
- (A) set the pace
 - (B) create an analogy
 - (C) establish the theme
 - (D) introduce a paradox
24. Lines 7–8, “Caribbean temper chilled / By guarded hostile looks,” are significant because they
- (A) compare the Caribbean landscape with the Canadian environment
 - (B) provide a contrast between the Caribbean temper and the hostile looks
 - (C) suggest that the woman had to adapt her attitude to suit the environment
 - (D) emphasize that the woman has not changed since she migrated to Canada
25. The effect of the poet’s references to the Caribbean’s “insane jungle rhythms” (line 24) and “fevered tingle of rum punches”(line 27) is that they
- (A) heighten the sense of nostalgia the woman feels
 - (B) suggest that the life the woman left behind was difficult
 - (C) mirror the woman’s experience in the new environment
 - (D) emphasize the coldness and hostility of the environment
26. Which of the following adjectives BEST describes the tone of the **last two** stanzas of the poem?
- (A) Impartial
 - (B) Sympathetic
 - (C) Disapproving
 - (D) Condescending
27. What do the images of the “land of silver dreams” (line 15) and the “dross of mass-produced catalogue-bought trifles” (line 17) tell us about the woman’s experience?
- (A) She recognizes the similarity in the environment.
 - (B) She was expecting to become wealthy in a short time.
 - (C) They highlight her fulfilment with her life in Canada.
 - (D) Her hope for a better life is undermined by the attitude of the people.
28. “The sun petulantly hides its head” (line 23) is an example of
- (A) irony and metaphor
 - (B) personification and simile
 - (C) symbolism and euphemism
 - (D) metaphor and personification

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29. The final stanza of the poem is used to
- (A) demonstrate that the woman's life in the Caribbean was difficult
 - (B) mirror the woman's life in the Caribbean and her life in Canada
 - (C) suggest that the woman's past was more gratifying than her present situation
 - (D) imply that the woman will not have a fulfilling life if she returns home
30. What is the poem MAINLY about?
- (A) Caribbean life
 - (B) Exile and return
 - (C) Fulfilment of dreams
 - (D) Dislocation and nostalgia

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Items 31–40

Instructions: Read the following poem carefully and then answer Items 31–40.

Beautiful Creatures Brief as These
(For Jay Macpherson)

Like butterflies but lately come
From long cocoons of summer
These little girls start back to school
To swarm the sidewalks, playing-fields,
5 And litter air with colour.

So slight they look within their clothes,
Their dresses looser than the Sulphur's wings,¹
It seems that even if the wind alone
Were not to break them in the lofty trees,
10 They could not bear the weight of *things*.

And yet they cry into the morning air
And hang from railings upside down
And laugh, as though the world were theirs
And all its buildings, trees, and stones
15 Were toys, were gifts of a benignant² sun.

D.G. Jones, *Literature in Canada Volume 2*, Gage
Educational Publishing, 1978, p. 469.

¹Sulphur's wings – reference to Zeus, the god of weather and atmospheric phenomena (for example, rain, lightning)

²Benignant – seemingly mild and kindly

31. What is suggested by the opening lines
“Like butterflies but lately come / From
long cocoons of summer”?

- (A) The butterflies are in cocoons.
- (B) The girls are going on a summer vacation.
- (C) The girls were on vacation and have returned to school.
- (D) The butterflies have been undergoing a transformation.

32. “Swarm the sidewalks” (line 4) and “litter
air with colour” (line 5) are examples of
which of the following literary devices?

- (A) Simile
- (B) Contrast
- (C) Metaphor
- (D) Euphemism

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33. The effect created by "So slight they look within their clothes" (line 6) is
- (A) an awareness of how delicate the girls seem
 - (B) a comparison of girls with butterflies
 - (C) an emphasis on the kind of clothes the girls wore
 - (D) a clearer image of the girls littering the air
34. The poet places "*things*" (line 10) in italics to
- (A) focus on the girls' weight
 - (B) emphasize the girls' frailty
 - (C) highlight the weakness of butterflies
 - (D) show that the lifespan of butterflies is quite short
35. The poet compares the girls with butterflies to
- (A) imply that they are carefree and full of life
 - (B) suggest that they are colourful and god-like
 - (C) hint that they are high-spirited and reserved
 - (D) indicate that they are flighty and uncontrollable
36. Which of the following statements is an example of contrast found in the poem?
- (A) Butterflies swarm the air and hang in cocoons.
 - (B) The dresses are looser than the Sulphur's wings.
 - (C) The girls look fragile yet they hang from the railings.
 - (D) The girls swarm the sidewalk yet they litter the air with colour.
37. "And laugh, as though the world were theirs" (line 13) is effective PRIMARILY because it
- (A) focuses on the girls' games
 - (B) confirms that the girls are wealthy
 - (C) compares the girls in their dresses with the Sulphur's wings
 - (D) emphasizes that the girls have conquered their environment
38. Which of the following words BEST describe the speaker's attitude to the girls?
- (A) Bemused and admiring
 - (B) Approving and resigned
 - (C) Despairing and outraged
 - (D) Complimentary and nostalgic
39. The poet gives symbolic significance to the
- I. lofty trees
 - II. Sulphur's wings
 - III. butterflies
- (A) I and II only
 - (B) I and III only
 - (C) II and III only
 - (D) I, II and III
40. The title of the poem, "Beautiful Creatures Brief as These", is effective MAINLY because it
- (A) suggests that the girls are beautiful and short
 - (B) comments on the short time when the butterflies flitted around
 - (C) indicates that the poet sees the girls as beautiful creatures who are not very strong
 - (D) implies that the vision of the girls as delicate beauties is quickly eroded by reality

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Items 41–50

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 41–50 on the basis of what is stated or implied.

One day, without meaning to, I broke a plate, the only plate of its kind that Eunice had ever owned, a plate made of bone china, and the words “I am sorry” would not pass my lips. The sadness she expressed over this loss fascinated me; it was so thick with grief, so overwhelming, so deep, as if the death of a loved one had occurred. She grabbed the thick pouch that was her stomach, she pulled at her hair. she
5 pounded her bosom; large tears rolled out of her eyes and down her cheeks, and they came in such profusion that if a new source of water had sprung up from them, as in a myth or a fairy tale, my small self would not have been surprised. I had been warned repeatedly by her not to touch this plate, for she had seen me look at it with an obsessive curiosity. I would look at it and wonder about the picture painted on its surface, a picture of a wide-open field filled with grass and flowers in the most tender shades of
10 yellow, pink, blue and green; the sky had a sun in it that shone but did not burn bright. This picture was nothing but a field full of grass and flowers on a sunny day, but it had an atmosphere of secret abundance, happiness and tranquility; underneath it was written in gold letters the one word HEAVEN.

When I broke the china plate on which this picture was painted and caused Ma Eunice to cry so, I did not immediately feel sorry, I did not feel sorry shortly after, I felt sorry only long afterward, and by then it
15 was too late to tell her so, she had died. When I broke the plate and would not say that I was sorry, she cursed my dead mother, she cursed my father, she cursed me. The words she used were without meaning; I understood them but they did not hurt me, for I did not love her. And she did not love me. She made me kneel down on her stone heap, with my hands raised high above my head and with a large stone in each hand. She meant to keep me in that position until I said the words “I am sorry,” but I would not say them.
20 I could not say them. It was beyond my own will; those words could not pass my lips. I stayed like that until she exhausted herself cursing me and all whom I came from.

As I was kneeling there I saw three land turtles crawling in and out of the small space under the house and I fell in love with them, I wanted to have them near me, I wanted to speak only to them each day for the rest of my life. Long after my ordeal was over – resolved in a way that did not please Ma Eunice for
25 I did not say I was sorry – I took all three turtles and placed them in an enclosed area where they could come and go as they pleased and so were completely dependent on me for their existence. I would bring to them the leaves of vegetables and water in small seashells. I thought them beautiful, their shells dark gray with faint yellow circles, their long necks, their unjudging eyes, the slow deliberateness of their crawl. But they would withdraw into their shells when I did not want them to, and when I called them,
30 they would not come out.

Adapted from Jamaica Kincaid, The Autobiography of My Mother, Penguin, 1997. pp. 8–12.

41. What narrative point of view is used in this passage?

- (A) First person
- (B) Second person
- (C) Third person limited
- (D) Third person omniscient

42. Which of the following characters is MOST likely the antagonist in the passage?

- (A) The father
- (B) Ma Eunice
- (C) The mother
- (D) The narrator

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43. The narrator in this extract is MOST likely a
- (A) woman reflecting on her childhood
 - (B) biological daughter opposing her mother
 - (C) teenager who detests living with her relatives
 - (D) child abused and abandoned by her relatives
44. The image of the narrator as observant and detached is supported by the way he or she
- (A) describes in detail Ma Eunice's sadness over the broken plate
 - (B) focuses on the beauty of the turtles' shells, necks, eyes and crawl
 - (C) describes her own attention to the plate as one of "obsessive curiosity"
 - (D) pays attention to the details on the plate and shows no remorse when it is broken
45. The narrator may be described as an anti-hero/heroine. Which of the following qualities support this description?
- I. He or she is unkind.
 - II. He or she is unloving.
 - III. He or she is unrepentant.
- (A) I and II only
 - (B) I and III only
 - (C) II and III only
 - (D) I, II and III
46. The action which BEST revealed that Ma Eunice was a disciplinarian was her
- (A) cursing of the narrator
 - (B) punishing of the narrator
 - (C) demanding an apology
 - (D) grieving over the broken plate
47. The narrator refused to apologize because he or she
- (A) rejected Ma Eunice's authority
 - (B) thought the punishment was extreme
 - (C) felt powerless before adults who punished him or her
 - (D) believed Ma Eunice should be punished for cursing him or her
48. Which of the following words BEST describe the tone of the passage?
- (A) Extreme anger
 - (B) Religious reverence
 - (C) Nostalgic aloofness
 - (D) Reflective resentment
49. The statement "But they would withdraw into their shells when I didn't want them to, and when I called them, they would not come out" (lines 29–30) suggests that the narrator wants to
- (A) dominate the vulnerable
 - (B) feel important and sociable
 - (C) love and care for the small creatures
 - (D) exert her authority and lack of control
50. The expression "unjudging eyes" (line 28) is an example of
- (A) simile
 - (B) oxymoron
 - (C) metaphor
 - (D) alliteration

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Items 51–60

Instructions: Read the following extract carefully and then answer Items 51–60.

May in Ayemenen is a hot, brooding month. The days are long and humid. The river shrinks and black crows gorge on bright mangoes in still, dustgreen trees. Red bananas ripen. Jackfruits burst. Dissolute bluebottles hum vacuously in the fruity air. The nights are clear but suffused with sloth and sullen expectation.

- 5 It was raining when Rahel came back to Ayemenen. Slanting silver ropes slammed into loose earth, plowing it up like gunfire. The old house on the hill wore its steep, garbled roof pulled over its ears like a low hat. The walls, streaked with moss, had grown soft, and bulged a little with dampness that seeped up from the ground. The wild overgrown garden was full of the whisper and scurry of small lives. Rahel had come to see her brother, Estha. They were two-egg twins. Estha – Esthappen – was
10 the older by eighteen minutes. But now, they are as old as Ammu was when she died. Thirty-one.

- They were nearly born on a bus, Estha and Rahel. The car in which Baba, their father, was taking Ammu, their mother to hospital in Shillong to have them, broke down on the winding tea-estate road in Assam. They abandoned the car and flagged down a crowded State Transport bus. With the queer compassion of the very poor for the comparatively well off, or perhaps only because they saw
15 how hugely pregnant Ammu was, seated passengers made room for the couple, and for the rest of the journey Estha and Rahel's father had to hold their mother's stomach (with them in it) to prevent it from wobbling.

- According to Estha, if they'd been born on the bus, they'd have got free bus rides for the rest of their lives. It wasn't clear where he'd got this information from, or how he knew these things, but
20 for years the twins harboured a faint resentment against their parents for having diddled them out of a lifetime of free bus rides.

- Estha had always been a quiet child, so no one could pinpoint with any degree of accuracy exactly when he had stopped talking. Stopped talking altogether, that is. The fact is that there wasn't an "exactly when." It had been a gradual winding down and closing shop. A barely noticeable quietening. As
25 though he had simply run out of conversation and had nothing left to say. Yet Estha's silence was never awkward. Never intrusive. Never noisy. It wasn't an accusing, protesting silence as much as a sort of a dormancy, the psychological equivalent of what lungfish do to get themselves through the dry season, except that in Estha's case the dry season looked as though it would last forever. Over time he had acquired the ability to blend into the background of wherever he was – into bookshelves,
30 gardens, curtains, doorways, streets – to appear inanimate, almost invisible to the untrained eye. It usually took strangers a while to notice him even when they were in the same room with him. It took them even longer to notice that he never spoke. Some never noticed at all. Estha occupied very little space in the world.

*Adapted from Arundhati Roy, The God of Small Things,
Random House, 1997, pp. 3–12.*

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51. The main purpose of the opening paragraph is to
- (A) emphasize the setting and convey the mood
 - (B) explain the conflict and introduce the characters
 - (C) depict the social environment and establish the pace
 - (D) describe the landscape and compare time and place
52. The MOST likely reason the narrator draws attention to the rain upon Rahel's return is to
- (A) use the rain as a symbol of violence and so heighten its dramatic effect
 - (B) highlight the contrast between the protagonist and the now-unfamiliar setting
 - (C) keep the setting natural, thus focusing completely on the characters and their actions
 - (D) parallel the protagonist's arrival with the arrival of the rain to compare and foreshadow their effects
53. Which of the following devices are used in the statement "The old house on the hill wore its steep, garbled roof pulled over its ears like a low hat" (lines 6–7)?
- (A) Metaphor and contrast
 - (B) Oxymoron and symbol
 - (C) Personification and simile
 - (D) Alliteration and onomatopoeia
54. In lines 8–9, "The wild overgrown garden was full of the whisper and scurry of small lives", the narrator draws attention to the garden's
- (A) neglect and nocturnal noises
 - (B) abandonment and animal life
 - (C) shabbiness and secretive silence
 - (D) desertion and concealed commotion
55. Estha's silence can BEST be described as
- (A) jarring and obvious
 - (B) fading and blending
 - (C) peaceful and strange
 - (D) non-invasive and genuine
56. The narrative device used in paragraph 3 is
- (A) backstory
 - (B) flashback
 - (C) flashforward
 - (D) foreshadowing

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57. Lines 20–21, “for years the twins harboured a faint resentment against their parents for having diddled them out of a lifetime of free bus rides”, serve MAINLY to
- (A) show the humour in childish imagination, expectation and naivety
 - (B) magnify the family’s poverty since they have to rely on free bus rides
 - (C) generalize about the curiosity, obsessiveness and possessiveness of twins
 - (D) emphasize the resentment children hold for their parents
58. In lines 25–28 “Yet Estha’s silence was never awkward ... as though it would last forever”, the narrator is asserting that Estha
- (A) wore silence as a form of rebellion
 - (B) clothed himself with silence to hide from reality
 - (C) adopted silence as an act of endurance and self-preservation
 - (D) chose silence to survive his harsh reality and project resentment
59. Estha’s “ability to blend into the background of wherever he was” (line 29) suggests that this character is
- (A) invisible to others who threaten him
 - (B) sensitive to an ever-changing environment
 - (C) afraid to confront and challenge strangers
 - (D) moody and unpredictable in his interaction with people
60. The third person subjective point of view of this extract gives rise to a tone that is BEST described as
- (A) playful
 - (B) sarcastic
 - (C) irreverent
 - (D) conversational

END OF TEST

IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS TEST.

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